

Performance

Under the hood, the third generation of Fire TV Cube offers plenty of power. It's Amazon's fastest Fire TV streaming media player to date as it comes powered by an all-new octa-core (4x2.0 GHz + 4x2.2GHz) processor making it 20 per cent more powerful than the previous generation Fire TV Cube.

This makes app launches through the Fire TV Cube super fast and fluid, thus elevating the streaming media player experience. This chipset is also responsible for what's generally good upscaling of low-resolution content, and playback of not just 4K ultra HD content but also content that's mastered for Dolby Vision and HDR. There's also support for Dolby ATMOS audio which works seamlessly on supported content on through the device. In our time with the Amazon Fire TV Cube 3rd Gen, the above-mentioned features worked as expected. The Fire TV OS improved the experience of playing content on a relatively old 4K HDR TV which has in the past frustrated me with its sluggish performance. The more sophisticated colour science used in the presets of the Fire TV Cube also helped visuals look better on the TV it was connected to. Further, it also connected seamlessly to the soundbar I use with the TV for a no-frills audio and visual experience.

Streaming experience in applications was also good, which I believe could be in part because of the support of Wi-Fi 6E on the device that creates a more stable and faster connection between the home router and the streaming device. Since it's a Fire TV OS device, which uses the Android TV code as its base, the Amazon Fire TV Cube 3rd Gen also gets access to over 10,000 applications in India. These include all your popular streaming applications including Netflix, Hotstar and Amazon's Prime Video.

Final word

The latest generation Fire TV Cube from Amazon is available at a slight, 1000 rupee premium over its predecessor. And trust you me, at this slight premium, it offers enough of an upgrade



to make it worthy of a recommendation. At Rs 13,999 it is an easy fix not only for your old smart, 4K HDR TV, but also can double up as a nice looking smart speaker in your living room.

However, that's only if you're looking for a smart speaker. If not, then there are more affordable options in the market to turn your smart TV, into a smarter, faster television. For example,

the Fire TV Stick Max from Amazon itself which is retailing for Rs 6,499. But before you go ahead and buy the more affordable Fire TV stick, do know that you'd be missing out on some forward-looking features such as the Wi-Fi 6E and of course the functionality of the Fire TV Cube 3rd-Gen to turn into an Alexa-based smart speaker all while looking really cool doing so. **d**